

RAJESH DAMMALA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Site Reliability Engineering leader with 16+ years transforming IT operations from reactive, process-heavy models into intelligent, technology-focused operating systems. Proven track record managing Incident, Problem, and Change Management as 24x7 operational functions while building AI-powered automation that reduces MTTD/MTTR and eliminates recurring issues at scale. Deep expertise in observability, SRE principles (SLOs, error budgets), and orchestration platforms across Azure cloud ecosystems. Passionate about automation-first, prevention over reaction, and engineering-focused team culture.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Site Reliability Engineering (SRE) • AI-Powered Operations & AIOps • Incident Management (24x7) • Problem Management & RCA • Change Management • Observability & Monitoring • SLOs / Error Budgets / SLIs • Automation & Orchestration • Global Team Leadership • Executive Communication • ITIL Framework • Predictive Operations

SELECTED IMPACT

- %, Transformed operations from 85% to 98% efficiency by shifting from process-heavy to technology-focused operating model with AI-driven automation
- %, Architected AI-powered incident automation platform achieving 30-35% autonomous resolution — reducing manual effort across detection, triage, and remediation
- %, Reduced mean time to resolve by 32% through intelligent incident workflows integrating monitoring, telemetry, and service context
- %, Eliminated 25,000+ recurring incidents and 500+ redundant alerts through data-driven Problem Management — identifying patterns and driving systemic fixes
- %, Built and scaled 24x7 global operations function with engineering-focused culture of ownership, innovation, and continuous improvement
- %, Authored 175+ operational playbooks establishing observability standards, signal quality, and guided remediation procedures

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Escalations Manager — Xbox CXT SRE | May 2021 – Present

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra) — Redmond, WA

- Manage full lifecycle of Incident, Problem, and Change Management as 24x7 operational function across 20+ mission-critical production services
- Transformed incident response with AI detection, correlation, and guided remediation — built Azure SRE AI Agent achieving 30-35% automated resolution
- Evolved Problem Management into data-driven discipline: pattern identification, recurring issue elimination, and systemic fixes reducing incidents by thousands
- Drive adoption of observability as foundation — Kusto/KQL telemetry, Power BI dashboards, Azure AppInsights for service-level visibility and actionable insights
- Lead development of automation and orchestration platforms reducing manual effort across outage lifecycle (detection !' triage !' communication !' RCA)
- Partner with engineering, infrastructure, and security teams aligning operations with service reliability goals and SLOs
- Deliver executive-level communication translating operational signals into clear, actionable narratives for leadership reviews
- Build high-performing team with culture of ownership, innovation, and continuous improvement

Azure Support Technical Lead — Customer Support Services | Nov 2016 – May 2021

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) — Redmond, WA

- Led team of 15 engineers scaling IT operations across Azure enterprise platform with growing scope and complexity
- Applied automation and analytics to improve operational outcomes — spearheaded support initiatives driving measurable reliability gains
- Managed escalation and incident response with SRE attitude — relentless urgency, accountability, prevention over reaction
- Cross-functional partnership with engineering and product teams to align operations with platform reliability goals

Operations Lead — Azure LiveSite Operations | May 2012 – Nov 2016

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) — Hyderabad, India !' Redmond, WA

- Led globally distributed team of 32 engineers (onshore/offshore) — scaled operations to support Azure platform growth
- Built PowerShell automation and orchestration reducing thousands of manual hours annually across monitoring and

remediation

- Owned Incident and Change Management across Azure infrastructure — cluster-to-blade level monitoring and observability

- Introduced risk-aware change management practices improving change success rates across large-scale infrastructure

- Created 200+ platform improvements and bug reports during monitoring/tooling onboarding initiatives

Systems Analyst / Data Center Engineer | Sep 2009 – Nov 2011

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) — Hammond, IN

- Infrastructure operations at scale: server builds, data center engineering, cluster configuration, large-scale data migrations

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Science — JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

SRE & Operations: Incident/Problem/Change Management, SLOs, Error Budgets, Observability, Reliability Practices

AI & Automation: Azure SRE AI Agent, AIOps, Logic Apps, Intelligent Workflows, Guided Remediation

Cloud & Infrastructure: Azure (AppInsights, Monitor, KeyVault, AD), AWS, GCP, VMware

Monitoring & Observability: Kusto/KQL, Power BI, Grafana, Azure Monitor, ServiceNow, ICM

Automation & Orchestration: PowerShell, Python, Terraform, Infrastructure as Code, CI/CD Pipelines

Frameworks: ITIL (Incident, Problem, Change, Configuration Management), SRE Principles, DevOps